

▶ THREADS

There are so many threads available and knowing which ones to choose can be confusing. There are specialist threads designed for special tasks, such as machine embroidery or quilting. Threads also vary in fibre content, from pure cotton to rayon to polyester. Some threads are very fine while others are thick and coarse. Failure to choose the correct thread can spoil your project and lead to problems with the stitch

COTTON THREAD

A 100 per cent cotton thread. Smooth and firm, this is designed to be used with cotton fabrics and is much favoured by quilters.



QUILTING THREAD

Quilting thread is heavier than sewing thread and is waxed to prevent breaks.



SILK THREAD

A sewing thread made from 100 per cent silk. Used for machining delicate fabrics. It is also used for tacking or temporary stitching in areas that are to be pressed, because it can be removed without leaving an imprint.



quality of the sewing machine. For piecing, it is important to match the thread to the fabric, such as cotton with cotton, to ensure they both shrink at the same rate. Match the colour to the lighter fabric or use a neutral shade. For appliqué, match the thread colour to the piece being stitched. Speciality threads include silk, metallics, and rayon.

SEWING THREAD

Threads come in a dazzling choice of colours, types, and weights. Sewing thread is used for hand- and machine-sewing.



POLYESTER ALL-PURPOSE THREAD

A good-quality polyester thread that has a very slight “give”, making it suitable to sew all types of fabrics. It is the most popular type of thread.



TOPSTITCHING THREAD

A thicker polyester thread used for decorative topstitching and buttonholes. Also for hand sewing buttons on thicker fabrics and some soft furnishings.

